INCH-POUND
A-A-55214A
September 13, 2022
SUPERSEDING
A-A-55214
July 12, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PILLOWCASE, COTTON AND POLYESTER/COTTON

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers the requirements for cotton and polyester/cotton pillowcases.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The pillowcase shall be of the following Types and Classes:

2.1 Types and classes.

Type I – Cotton

Class 1 – (140 count)
Class 2 – (140 count)
Class 3 – (140 count)
Class 4 – (140 count)
Class 5 – (180 count)

Type II – DELETED

Type III – Polyester-cotton (65/35) - Commercial designation No. 180 (percale)

Class 1 – (180 count)

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, and any data that may improve this document should be sent to: Attn: DLA Troop Support, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5096. Since contact information can change, verify the currency of the address information using Acquisition Streamlining and Standardization Information System (ASSIST) online database https://assist.dla.mil.

AMSC N/A FSC 7210

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Type IV – Polyester-cotton (50/50) - Commercial designation No. 128 (muslin)

Class 1 – (128 count)
Class 2 – (128 count)
Class 3 – (128 count)
Class 4 – (128 count)
Class 5 – (128 count)

Type V – Polyester-cotton (50/50) - Commercial designation No. 180 (percale)

Class 1 – (180 count)
Class 2 – (180 count)

Type VI – Polyester-cotton (65/35) - Commercial designation No. 128 (muslin)

Class 1 – (128 count)
Class 2 – (128 count)
Class 3 – (128 count)

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Description. The pillowcase shall be made of one (1) rectangular-shaped piece of plain-weave sheeting cloth. The pillowcase shall be hemmed and conform to the requirements listed in Table I.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Basic material. The basic material for the pillowcase shall be as follows:

Type I – The cloth for Classes 1-4 shall be made from of carded, drawn, or spun cotton, that has been bleached white or dyed as specified in the contractor or purchase order. The cloth shall conform to the requirements specified in Table I.

Type I – The cloth for Class 5 shall be made from of carded, combed, drawn and spun cotton, that has been bleached white. The cloth shall conform to the requirements specified in Table I.

Type III – The cloth for Class 1 shall be made from 65 (± 5)% polyester and the remainder cotton, that has been bleached white. The cloth shall conform to the requirements specified in Table I.

Types IV and V – The cloth for Type IV, Classes 1-5 and Type V, Classes 1, 2 shall be made from 50 (± 5)% polyester and the remainder cotton, that has been bleached white. The cloth shall conform to the requirements specified in Table I.

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Type VI – The cloth for Classes 1-3 shall be made from 65 (± 5)% polyester and the remainder cotton, that has been dyed as specified in the contract or purchase order. The cloth shall conform to the requirements specified in Table I.

3.2.2 Color. The color shall be as specified in the contract or procurement documents for dyed Types listed in Table I (see 7.4). The finished pillowcase shall match the standard sample for shade and appearance and shall be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced.

3.2.2.1 Visual shade matching. The color and appearance of the material shall match the standard sample when viewed using the AATCC EP9, Option C, (see 7.4.1) with sources simulating artificial daylight D_{75} illuminant with a color temperature of 7500 (± 200) K illumination of 100 (± 20) foot candles, and shall be a good match to the standard sample under incandescent A illuminant with a color temperature of 2856 (± 200) K.

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TABLE I. Physical and colorfastness requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement						Test method
	Type I		Type III	Type IV	Type V	Type VI	
	Bleached or dyed	Bleached	Bleached	Bleached	Bleached	Dyed	
	Class 1-4	Class 5	Class 1	Class 1-5	Class 1-2	Class 1-3	
Weight, oz./sq.yd. (min.)	4.2	3.4	3.4	3.4	3.4	3.4	ASTM D3776/D3776, Opt. C
Yarns per inch (min.) 1/							
Warp	74	98	97	68	98	66	ASTM D3775
Filling	69	82	80	60	82	56	
Breaking Strength, lbs. (min.)							
Warp	60	65	60	45	65	50	ASTM D5034
Filling	60	65	60	45	65	50	
Colorfastness, grade: (min.) 2/							
Laundering (Color change and staining)	4	--	--	--	--	4	AATCC TM 61, Test 1A, 3/, 4/
Crocking (dry/wet)	3.5	--	--	--	--	3.5	AATCC TM8 5/
Dimensional stability, % (max.)							
Warp	3.0	3.0	3.0	5.0	3.0	3.0	AATCC 135 (1), (V), (A)
Filling	3.0	3.0	3.0	5.0	3.0	3.0	

1/ A minus tolerance of 7 yarns per inch for Type I, Classes 1-4, 8 yarns per inch for the Type I, Class 5 and Type V, Classes 1-2, and 6 yarns per inch for the Type IV, Classes 1-5 and Type V, Classes 1-3 in either the warp or filling shall be permitted provided there is a total of the minimum specified respectively in both the warp and filling combined.

2/ Dyed cloth only.

3/ Test 1A, except that the temperature shall be 160 (±) 4°F

4/ Rated using the AATCC EP1, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Color Change and AATCC EP2, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Staining.

5/ Rated using the AATCC EP8, Evaluation Procedure for AATCC 9-Step Chromatic Transference Scale.

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3.2.3 Labile sulfur. The use of dyes and compounds containing sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The cloth shall be "Free" of labile sulfur when tested as specified in 3.2.3.1.

3.2.3.1 Presence of labile sulfur test. Two (2) 1.50 (± 0.01) gram samples from each sample unit shall be tested. Each of the two (2) samples shall be cut into very small pieces and placed into separate test tubes. Prepare an acidic tin(II) chloride (stannous chloride) solution by dissolving 100 g $SnCl_2$ (ACS grade) in 100 mL of 35% hydrochloric acid (ACS grade) and adding the mixture to 50 mL of distilled water. Prepare a lead acetate solution by dissolving 5.0 g of lead acetate (CP reagent grade) in a small amount of distilled water and diluting to a total of 100 mL. If the solution is not clear, add a few drops (one at a time) of glacial acetic acid until the solution is clear. The samples shall be submersed the acidic tin(II) chloride solution. A filter paper wet out with the lead acetate solution shall be placed over the top of the test tube. The test tube containing the textile sample, tin(II) chloride and wet filter paper shall be heated over a low flame until the solution is boiling. The solution should not be heated for more than 15 seconds. A brown to black stain on the filter paper should be evaluated as follows:

Free	-	The filter paper shows no discoloration or staining of any kind.
Slight	-	The filter paper shows a light tan to light brown discoloration stain.
Moderate	-	The filter paper shows a dark brown discoloration stain.
Severe	-	The filter paper shows a black color stain.

The rating shall be recorded. The results shall be recorded as "pass" or "fail.

3.3 Thread. The thread for hemming and seaming shall be white or as specified in the contract or procurement documents. The thread shall be either cotton, A-A-52094, Type I, 40 Tex, 3-ply; or cotton-covered polyester thread, A-A-50199, Type I, 33 Tex, 2-ply; or polyester spun, A-A-59989, 30 Tex, 2 or 3-ply. The color for Type I shall approximate the shade of the basic material. The color of the thread for hemming Types III, IV, V, and VI shall be shade Orange.

3.4 Stitches, Seams and Stitching. All stitching shall be 10–16 stitches per inch and conform to ASTM D6193. When one or two selvages are seamed, a lock stitch or chain stitch shall be used. Stitching shall be 1/8 - 5/8 inch from the selvage edge. As an alternate, a 5/32 - 1/4-inch overedge stitch, or a lock stitch or chain stitch, 3/8 - 5/8 inch from the edge may be used. The pillowcases shall be seamed, and the seams shall be straight when pillowcases are laid flat. When one selvage and one non-selvage of material are joined, they shall be stitched with a 5/32 - 1/4-inch overedge, or a chain stitch 3/8 - 5/8 inch from the material edge. A lock stitching, when not caught in other seams and stitches, shall be bartacked not less than 1/2-inch at seam ends and stitching. Thread breaks shall be secured by stitching the-back of the break not less than 1/2-inch.

3.5 Hems. The hem shall be of uniform width as specified in Table II. The hem shall be produced by turning the edge of the material under 1/2 (± 1/4) inch, folding it back over the body of the material and stitching the turned and folded portion of the body of the material with one row of single-needle, straight-lock stitches at a minimum of ten (10) stitches in.

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TABLE II. Finished measurements (inches).

	Hems 1/	Pillowcase after hemming 2/	
Type and Class	Width	Width	Length
Type I			
Class 1	1	20-1/2	27-1/2
Class 2	3	20-1/2	32-1/2
Class 3	3	22-1/4	32-1/2
Class 4	1	20-1/2	30-1/2
Class 5	3	20-1/2	32-1/2
Type III			
Class 1	1	20-1/2	30-1/2
Type IV			
Class 1	1	21	31-1/8
Class 2	3	21	33-1/8
Class 3	1	21	33-1/8
Class 4	1	21	28
Class 5	1	22-3/4	33-1/8
Type V			
Class 1	1	20-1/2	30-1/2
Class 2	3	20-1/2	32-1/2
Type VI			
Class 1	1	20-1/2	30-1/2
Class 2	3	20-1/2	32-1/2
Class 3	1	20-1/2	32-1/2

1/ The finished tolerance for the hem width shall be ± 1/4 inch for all types and classes.
2/ The finished tolerance for the pillowcase after hemming in the width and length direction shall be ± 1/2 inch (each direction).

3.6 Label. Each pillowcase shall be labeled and marked in accordance with MIL-DTL-32075, Type III or IV, Class 9. Unless otherwise specified, the printing shall be black, and each pillowcase shall have the block letters "US" 1/2 (± 1/16) inch in height. Medical procurements shall have a caduceus 1-7/8 (± 1/8) inch in height centered between the black letters "U" and "S" 1/2 (± 1/16) inch in height in accordance with Type I of MS 16686. Markings shall be done on the inside. As an alternate, the marking may be done with a sewn-in label.

3.7.1 Barcode hang tag. Each pillowcase shall have a barcode label/hangtag conforming to Type VIII, Class 17 of MIL-DTL-32075. The bar-coding element shall be a 13-digit National Stock Number (NSN). There shall be a 12-digit Universal Product Code (UPC) number assigned for all NSNs by the contracting activity. The initials “UPC” must appear beneath the code. The barcode for NSN and UPC type shall be a medium to high density and shall be located so that it is completely visible on the pillowcase when it is folded and/or packaged as specified and so it causes no damage to the pillowcase.

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3.8 Toxicity. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or procurement documents, the finished pillowcase shall not present a health hazard and shall show compatibility with prolonged, direct skin contact when tested as specified in 3.8.1.

3.8.1 Toxicity test. When the toxicity requirement (see 3.8) can be demonstrated with historical use data, on the finishing treatments used, toxicity testing may not be required (see 7.1.4 and 7.5).

3.9 Workmanship. The finished pillowcase shall conform to the quality of the product established in this document. The pillowcase shall be free from defects which would affect its serviceability, appearance, uniformity, and quality assurance standards defined by the technical data in the procurement documents.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Unless otherwise specified, the offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered, recycled, bio based, and environmentally preferable materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403, 23.404(b) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation FAR, or the sustainable acquisition of EO 13693; as applicable. (See 7.1.2).

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The pillowcase shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptability. The finished pillowcase offered must have been sold to the government or commercial market.

5.3 End item inspection procedures. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection of Attributes (see 7.2.2).

5.4 Visual examination. Each pillowcase shall be examined for the defects listed in Table III as defined in ASTM D3990. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one (1) pillowcase. The sample unit shall be one (1) pillowcase.

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TABLE III. Visual examination defects.

Material defects: Any hole, cut, tear, or slash, slob, floats, or skips; any club, slug, gout, jerked-in filling, or slough off, any spot or stain (outside), color not as specified. Any mend, abrasion mark, or broken or missing yarn. Objectionable odor.
Stitches, seams and stitching: Dropped stitch, needle chew, any open seam, raw edge, broken stitches. Any part pleated or caught or twisted in an unrelated row of stitching. Hem not as specified, or twisted, pleated or puckered hem. Wrong seam or stitch type, or seam allowance; wrong thread tension; inappropriate backstitching, or insufficient stitches per inch.
Workmanship: Not made of one piece of material. Design and construction not as described. Not specified size, poorly shaped. Measurement of item not as specified. Failure to meet product conformance; serviceability, reliability and quality of materials as defined by this document.
Labels: Label(s) missing, incorrect, or illegible; marking omitted, illegible, or not as specified; any strike-through on outside of the pillowcase. Bar code or UCP cod label/tag omitted or not readable by scanner, Human-Readable Interpretation (HRI) omitted or illegible, bar code type not as specified, code density not as specified or visible. Bar code label causes damage to the item.
Packaging: Not packaged in accordance with the contract or purchase documents.

5.5 Dimensional examination. The finished pillowcases shall conform to the dimensions specified in Table II, when measured after hemming. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one (1) pillowcase.

5.6 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or procurement documents (see 7.6).

6. PACKAGING. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 7.6).

7. NOTES.

7.1 Source of Government documents:

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

7.1.2 EO 13693 information is available online at https://www.epa.gov.

7.1.3 Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) are available online at https://acquisition.gov.

7.1.4 Toxicity testing. If dermal toxicity testing is required, it will be conducted using Title 40, Protection of Environment, Code of Federal Regulations current edition and applicable sections, which are also consistent with the following OECD tests:

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Skin Sensitization 406 and Dermal Irritation 404 (https://www.oecd-ilibrary.org/environment/oecd-guidelines-for-the-testing-of-chemicals-section-4-health-effects_20745788?page=1).

Dermal Sensitization (https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/40/798.4100)
Dermal Toxicity (https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/40/798.2250)

7.2 Source of non-Government documents.

7.2.1 AATCC Standards are available for purchase online at https://www.atcc.org.

7.2.2 ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures are available online at https://www.asq.org.

7.2.3 ASTM Standards are available for purchase online at https://www.astm.org.

7.3 Intended use. The item is intended to be used for bedding by all the military services and non-military agencies of the Federal Government.

7.4 Standard samples. For access to standard shade samples of cloth, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

7.4.1 Visual shade matching. In 2017, Option A of AATCC EP9 was changed to Option C. NOTE: In case of confusion, the viewing geometry should be "The specimen plane and illumination source will be parallel to each other and aligned so that the light flux is incident at the center of the specimen plane, which is set at a 35 (± 5º) angle relative to the horizontal. The observer will view the specimens at a 90º angle, relative to the plane of the specimens".

7.5 Certificate of compliance. The contracting activity may select to accept a certificate of compliance for a stated requirement.

7.6 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description
b. Type, and class required (see 2.1)
c. Color required (see 3.2.2)
d. Toxicity testing, if required (see 3.8)
e. Product conformance provisions (see 5.1)
f. Acceptance criteria (see 5.6)
g. Packaging requirements (see 6.)

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7.7 National Stock Number (NSNs). The following is a list of NSNs assigned that correspond to this CID. This list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID and are provided for reference only.

NSN	Color	Size
7210-00-231-2373	White	20.5 X 30.5 Inches Nominal

7.7 Key words.

Count
Plain weave

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army – GL
Navy – NU
Air Force – 11

Review Activities:
Army - MD
Navy – MC, SH

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FAS

Preparing Activity:
DLA-CT

(Project: 7210-2022-002)

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